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Özge Bakay

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Research Interests

Psycholinguistics, Turkish sentence processing, bilingualism, eye-tracking, computational linguistics

Academic Appointments

Postdoctoral Researcher — **University of Michigan Ann Arbor**, Department of Linguistics, 11/2026 –
Project: *Predictive processing in naturalistic language comprehension through EEG and computational modeling* (NSF #2518249)
Co-PIs: Jonathan Brennan & Edith Kaan

Education

Ph.D. — **University of Massachusetts Amherst**, Linguistics, 2026
Dissertation: *Structuring linguistic memory: Investigations on the Turkish reciprocal*
Co-Chairs: Brian Dillon & Faruk Akkuş
Committee: Adrian Staub, Dave Kush & Shota Momma

M.A. — **Boğaziçi University**, Foreign Language Education, 2020 (GPA: 3.88/4.00)
Thesis: *Processing Turkish center-embeddings: An investigation of case interference and prosodic phrase lengths* [pdf]
Advisor: Nazik Dinçtopal Deniz

B.A. — **Boğaziçi University**, Foreign Language Education, 2017 (GPA: 3.72/4.00)
Certificates (equivalent to minor degrees) in Linguistics & French

Université de Strasbourg, Educational Sciences, exchange student, Fall 2016
French as the medium of instruction

Research Publications

Journal Articles

1. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., Staub, A., & Dillon, B. (Submitted). Structurally prominent linguistic items hold a privileged state in working meory: Time-course evidence for rapid access. [pdf].

2. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., & Dillon, B. (2026). Hierarchical relations guide memory retrieval in sentence comprehension: Evidence from a local anaphor in Turkish. *Journal of Memory and Language*, *148*, 104747. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2026.104747

3. Deniz, N. D., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Deniz, C. M. (2026). Subject–verb agreement by Turkish speakers of English: Differential cue-weighting in L1 and L2 and distinct mechanisms for comprehension and production. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 1–12. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728926101497

4. Deniz, N. D., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Kurt, D. (2023). (Reversed) Mismatch Asymmetry in English Subject-Verb Agreement. *Dilbilim Araştırmaları Dergisi [Journal of Linguistics Research]*, *34*(1), 1–26. https://doi.org/10.18492/dad.1181172

5. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Avar, B., & Yıldız, O. T. (2019). A tree-based approach for English-to-Turkish translation. *Turkish Journal of Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences*, *27*(1), 437–452. https://doi.org/10.3906/elk-1807-341

Conference Proceedings

1. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Akkuş, F. (To appear). Experimental evidence for partial conjunct agreement in Turkish. *Proceedings of the 61st Chicago Linguistics Society (CLS)*. [pdf]. (Presented as a talk at the University of Chicago, slides).

2. Calderón Corona, M., & **Bakay**, **Ö.** (In progress). Resolving semantic ambiguity via agreement: The case of Spanish adjectival conjuncts. *Proceedings of the 31st Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)*. [poster].

3. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Yıldız, O. K., Bhatt, R., Dillon, B., & Yldız, O. T. (2026). From Dependency to CCG to Incremental CCG: Approaches to Flexible Word Order in Turkish. *Proceedings of the 30th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning (CoNLL)*. [pdf].

4. Türk, U., Neu, E., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Jarosz, G., & Dillon, B. (2026). Frequency modulates structural choice in Turkish suspended affixation: A latent-process account. *Proceedings of the 9th Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL)*. [pdf].

5. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Oğuz, M. (2024). Investigating syntactic effects in NPI illusions in Turkish. *Proceedings of the 9th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in contact with Turkic (Tu+)*. [pdf]. (Presented as a poster at Cornell University, poster).

6. Öksal, C., Oğuz, H. N., ..., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Yıldız, O. T. (2022). Time travel in Turkish: WordNets for Modern Turkish. *Proceedings of Globalex Workshop on Linked Lexicography within the 13th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC)*, 75–84. [pdf].

7. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Ergelen, Ö., Sarmış, E., Yıldırım, S., Arıcan, B. N., Kocabalcıoğlu, A., Özçelik, M., Sanıyar, E., Kuyrukçu, O., Avar, B., & Yıldız, O. T. (2021). Turkish WordNet KeNet. *Proceedings of the 11th Global Wordnet Conference (GWC)*, 166–174. [pdf]. (Presented as a virtual talk).

8. Özçelik, M., Arıcan, B. N., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Sarmış, E., Ergelen, Ö., Bayezit, N. G., & Yıldız, O. T. (2021). HisNet: A polarity lexicon based on wordnet for emotion analysis. *Proceedings of the 11th Global Wordnet Conference (GWC)*, 157–165. [pdf].

9. Kara, N., Aslan, D. B., Marşan, B., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Ak, K., & Yıldız, O. T. (2020). TRopBank: Turkish PropBank v2.0. *Proceedings of the 12th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC)*, 2763–2772. [pdf].

10. Arıcan, B. N., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Avar, B., Yıldız, O. T., & Ergelen, Ö. (2019). English-Turkish parallel semantic annotation of Penn-Treebank. *Proceedings of the 10th Global Wordnet Conference (GWC)*, 298–306. [pdf].

11. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Avar, B., & Yıldız, O. T. (2019). Comparing sense categorization between English PropBank and English WordNet. *Proceedings of the 10th Global Wordnet Conference (GWC)*, 307–314. [pdf].

12. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Ergelen, Ö., & Yıldız, O. T. (2019). Integrating Turkish WordNet KeNet to Princeton WordNet: The case of one-to-many correspondences. *Proceedings of the 5th Innovations in Intelligent Systems and Applications Conference (ASYU)*, 1–5. [pdf]. (Presented as a talk at Yaşar University, İzmir, Turkey).

13. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Ergelen, Ö., & Yıldız, O. T. (2019). Problems caused by semantic drift in WordNet synset construction. *Proceedings of the 4th International Conference on Computer Science and Engineering (UBMK)*, 1–5. [pdf]. (Presented as a talk at 19 Mayıs University, Samsun, Turkey).

14. Özçelik, R., Uludoğan, G., Parlar, S., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Ergelen, Ö., & Yıldız, O. T. (2019). User interface for Turkish Word Network KeNet. *Proceedings of the 27th Signal Processing and Communications Applications Conference (SIU)*, 1–4. [pdf].

15. Ak, K., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Taner Yıldız, O. (2018). Comparison of Turkish Proposition Banks by Frame Matching. *Proceedings of the 3rd International Conference on Computer Science and Engineering (UBMK)*, 352–356. [pdf].

Books & Reports

1. **Bakay**, **Ö.** (2020). *A report on the elective Laz courses offered by the Ministry of Education in Turkey: 2013-2020 [in Turkish]*. Laz Institute, İstanbul, Turkey. [pdf].

2. Özkurt, M., Büyüklü, O., Alper, M., Demirok, Ö., Eren, Ö., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Balcı, S. (2018). *Lazuri doviguram [Teaching material for adult learners of the Laz language].* Lazika Yayıncılık, İstanbul, Turkey.

Presentations

Unless indicated as an *invited talk*, all entries are peer-reviewed conference presentations without proceedings.

1. **Bakay**, **Ö.** (2026). *Structuring linguistic memory: Time-course evidence for rapid access to structurally prominent linguistic representations* [S/lab, University of California Santa Cruz, invited talk].

2. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., Staub, A., & Dillon, B. (2026). *Hierarchical information mediates time-course of access to items in linguistic memory.* [39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), poster] [poster].

3. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Türk, U., Demiray, D., & Dillon, B. (2026). *Tracking structural cues or relying on probabilistic inference in Turkish agreement?* [11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+), talk].

4. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Türk, U., Demiray, D., & Dillon, B. (2026). *Tracking structural cues or relying on probabilistic inference in Turkish agreement?* [39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), talk] [slides].

5. Neu, E., Türk, U., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Dillon, B., & Jarosz, G. (2026). *Frequency modulates structural choices in turkish non-local derivational morphemes* [39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), poster] [poster].

6. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Akkuş, F. (2025). *An experimental investigation of conjunct agreement in Turkish.* [10th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+), University of Southern California, talk] [slides].

7. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., & Dillon, B. (2025). *Hierarchical relations guide memory retrieval: Evidence from a local anaphor in Turkish.* [Sentence Processing Workhop at the University of Potsdam, invited talk] [abstract].

8. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., & Dillon, B. (2025). *Hierarchical relations in memory retrieval: Evidence from a local anaphor in Turkish.* [38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of Maryland].

9. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., & Dillon, B. (2024). *The role of c-command in processing a pre-verbal anaphor in Turkish* [9th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+), Cornell University, talk].

10. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Oğuz, M. (2024). *Investigating syntactic effects in NPI illusions in Turkish* [37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), Michigan University] [poster].

11. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Önder, S., Marşan, B., Gökgöz, K., & Arslan Kechriotis, C. (2024). *Summer language gains and community building at Boğaziçi University's Immersive Turkish Language and Culture Program* [Georgetown University Round Table (GURT), Georgetown University, talk] [slides].

12. Deniz, N. D., **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Kornfilt, J. (2024). *Effects of surprisal in (long-distance) licensing of Turkish NPIs* [37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of Michigan] [poster].

13. **Bakay**, **Ö.** (2023). *The role of structural cues and recency in processing a pre-verbal anaphor in Turkish.* [Neurolinguistics Summer Meetings at Boğaziçi University, İstanbul, Turkey, invited talk].

14. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Akkuş, F., & Dillon, B. (2023). *The role of structural cues and recency in processing a pre-verbal anaphor in Turkish* [29th Annual Conference on Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), Basque Center on Cognition, Brain and Language, San Sebastian, Spain].

15. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Burnsky, J., Keshev, M., Asatryan, M., Johnson, K., & Dillon, B. (2023). *Predicting disjoint reference: offline and online evidence* [36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of Pittsburgh] [poster].

16. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Dillon, B. (2022). *C-command effects in binding third-person reflexives and pronoun in Turkish.* [35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of California Santa Cruz, virtual poster presentation] [abstract].

17. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Deniz, N. D. (2021). *Case interference and phrase length effects in processing Turkish center-embeddings.* [34th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of Pennsylvania, virtual poster presentation] [slides].

18. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Gürel, A. (2021). *An investigation of late closure in adverb attachment preferences of L1 and L2 speakers of Turkish.* [20th International Conference on Turkish Linguistics (ICTL), Eskişehir Anadolu University, Eskişehir, Turkey, virtual talk] [abstract].

19. Kurt, D., & **Bakay**, **Ö.** (2021). *The role of animacy in processing ditransitive verbs in Turkish [in Turkish].* [34th National Linguistics Congress (UDK), Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey, virtual talk] [abstract].

20. **Bakay**, **Ö.** (2020). *An investigation of morphosyntactic case interference and prosodic phrase lengths in Turkish center-embeddings* [Student Conference on Linguistics (SCOL), Boğaziçi University, talk].

21. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, & Deniz, N. D. (2020). *Missing-verb illusion in Turkish center-embeddings?: An investigation of case interference and phrase lengths.* [24th Annual Conference on Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), University of Potsdam, virtual poster presentation] [slides].

22. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Bozyiğit, E., Sobucalı, G., Yıldırım, S., & Bayyurt, Y. (2018). *Non-native speakers' perceptions of the intelligibility of Turkish in Turkey.* [19th International Conference on Turkish Linguistics (ICTL), Nazarbayev University, Astana, Kazakhstan, talk] [slides].

23. **Bakay**, **Ö.**, Haznedar, B., & Avcı, İ. (2018). *The current status of the Laz language and the Laz-speaking communities in Turkey [in Turkish].* [32th National Linguistics Congress (UDK), Dokuz Eylül University, İzmir, Turkey, talk].

Fellowships & Awards

2025 – now	Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant, National Science Foundation (NSF #2518020) for *Hierarchical relations in real-time sentence comprehension*
	Dissertation Fieldwork Grant, University of Massachusetts Amherst
2021 – 2022	University Fellowship, University of Massachusetts Amherst
2020	Prof. Dr. Cem Alptekin Award for Academic Success Foreign Language Education Department, Boğaziçi University
2017 – 2020	Scientific and Technical Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK) - MA scholarship
2012 – 2017	Credit and Dormitories Institution (KYK) – BA scholarship

Research Assistantships

2022 – 2025 Processing Negative Polarity Items in L1 and L2 Turkish (TÜBİTAK #221K063)
PI: Nazik Dinçtopal Deniz, Boğaziçi University

2022 – 2023 Disjoint reference in real-time comprehension: Computational and cross-linguistic perspectives (NSF #1941485)
PI: Brian Dillon, University of Massachusetts Amherst

2019 An investigation of working memory and prosodic phrasing in processing complex sentences in the second language (Boğaziçi University (BAP) #13781)
PI: Nazik Dinçtopal Deniz, Boğaziçi University

2017 – 2019 Creation of a Turkish WordNet and its usage in machine translation (TÜBİTAK #116E104)
PI: Olcay Taner Yıldız, Işık University

2017 Development of Mother Tongue-Based Multilingual Education in the Laz Language (EU-funded; titled *LAZ-DEMO*)
Organization: Laz Institute, İstanbul, Turkey

Memberships

2023 – Society for Human Sentence Processing

2021 – 2026 Graduate Linguistics Student Association of the University of Massachusetts Amherst

Teaching

Linguistics
- TA for Introduction to Syntax, Instructor: Kyle Johnson, Fall 2025
  Held office hours
- TA for Introduction to Syntax, Instructor: Faruk Akkuş, Spring 2025
  Held office hours
- TA for Language Processing and the Brain, Instructor: Shota Momma, Fall 2024
  Held office hours, guest lectured on 'Eye-tracking methodology'
- TA for Language and Cognition, Instructor: John Kingston, Spring 2024
  Held office hours, held a lab on 'Replication of Kush & Dillon (2021)'
- TA for People and Their Language, Instructor: Rajesh Bhatt, Fall 2023
  Held office hours and discussion sessions [materials here]

Language
- Instructor at Turkish Language and Culture Program, Boğaziçi University, 2018-2026
  Taught Turkish grammar, reading, writing and speaking classes for foreigners
- Instructor, Bahçeşehir University PREP School for English, 2020-2021
  Taught English classes for Turkish students at the university-level
- TA at Turkish Language and Culture Program, Boğaziçi University, 2015-2017
  Held lab and conversation hours for Turkish for foreigners

Professional Service

Administration	Administrative Assistant for the Turkish Language and Culture Program Boğaziçi University, 2018-2023
Co-organizer	36th Annual Symposium on Arabic Linguistics (ASAL) University of Massachusetts Amherst, 2023
	Syntax-Semantics Reading Group University of Massachusetts Amherst, 2022-2023
	ECO-5 (Graduate Student Conference from five East Coast universities) University of Connecticut, 2023
Co-editor	Proceedings of the 52nd North East Linguistics Society (NELS) University of Massachusetts Amherst, 2022
Reviewer	Journal of Memory and Language
	Language, Cognition and Neuroscience
	Dilbilim Araştırmaları Dergisi [Journal of Linguistics Research]
	Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic [Tu+]
	Chicago Linguistics Society [CLS]

Skills

Coding	R, PCIbex, EyeLink Experiment Builder, LaTeX, Python (basic)
Training	Introduction to Bayesian data analysis *The 7th summer school on statistical methods for Linguistics and Psychology* *University of Potsdam, 2023*
	Advanced methods in frequentist statistics with Julia *The 6th summer school on statistical methods for Linguistics and Psychology* *University of Potsdam, 2022*
Languages	Turkish (native language), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Laz (beginner/research)